Keep connected things safe

IoT · Level 4 · Lesson 3



Today you will

- Explain how attackers take over devices with default passwords, and what a botnet is.
- Secure a device: a new strong password, updates, and only the features you use.
- Decide what a device should and shouldn't collect.

Lock it down

- Change the default password
- Turn on automatic updates
- Switch off what you don't use
- Collect only what's needed

Device safety check

1. Pick one family device, with an adult.
2. Check that the password has been changed.
3. Check that updates are automatic.
4. Find features nobody uses.
5. List what it collects, and what it needn't.

Only check devices your family owns, with an adult. Never put a password in your notes or photos, and never try to log in to anyone else's device.

Let’s discuss

1. Why did Mirai find so many devices so easily?
2. Which feature at home would you switch off, and why?
3. Who should keep devices safe: the maker, the shop or the owner?

Check yourself

- Name two habits that would have stopped Mirai.